
Employment History

July 2023–Now **Associate Professor**, *University of California, San Diego, CA*
May 2025–Now **Founder & Chief Scientist**, *Okalai AI, San Diego, CA*
Jan 2017– 2023 **Assistant Professor**, *University of California, San Diego, CA*
2013– 2016 **Postdoctoral Fellow**, *Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA*
Summer 2011 **Intern**, *Microsoft Research, Redmond, WA*
Summer 2008 **Intern**, *IBM Zurich Research, Switzerland*

Academic History

2009–2012 **Ph.D. in Computer Science (Summa cum laude)**, *Max Planck Institute for Informatics & Saarland University, Germany*
Advisor: Gerhard Weikum
2002–2009 **B.Sc (2005), B.Sc Honors (2006, First Class) M.Sc (2009, with Distinction)**,
University of Cape Town, South Africa
Advisor: Hussein Suleman
1997–2001 **Cambridge HIGCSE**, *Oshigambo High School, Namibia*

Selected Awards

2022 NSF CAREER Award
2019 Hellman Fellow
2017 Peggy and Peter Preuss Faculty Scholar
2014 Otto Hahn Medal (awarded for PhD dissertation by the Max Planck Society)
2012 Best Paper Award Runner Up at the EMNLP 2012 Conference
2012 Best Paper Award at the AKBC Workshop
2006 DAAD-TUCSIN Undergraduate Scholarship
2003 Class Medals for Computer Science Courses (awarded to top grade in the class)
2002 Class Medals for Computer Science Courses (awarded to top grade in the class)

Academic Service

regular Area Chair, ACL, EMNLP, NAACL
regular Area Chair, ICLR
regular Area Chair, NeurIPS
regular Area Chair, ICML